

SKILLS GUIDE



Strong communication skills to explain faults to clients who have limited technical knowledge.



Strength for lifting and reaching inaccessible parts, and stamina to concentrate for long periods.



Good problem-solving skills for investigating, diagnosing, and fixing mechanical faults.



Manual dexterity to use a wide variety of tools and handle complex vehicle components.



Precision and attention to detail to disassemble parts and reassemble them correctly.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MECHANICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 182–183*
- ▶ **AUTO DAMAGE APPRAISER** Inspects vehicles that have been damaged in accidents to estimate the cost of repair.
- ▶ **AUTO PARTS ADVISOR/SALESPERSON** Orders and sells vehicle parts and accessories in addition to providing advice to customers on vehicle faults and other troubleshooting issues.
- ▶ **MOTOR VEHICLE BODY REPAIRER** Fixes, restores, and refinishes damaged vehicle parts. Repairers also inspect vehicles for damage, replace or repair affected body panels, and refinish paintwork.

Once qualified, the best way to find work is to approach employers directly; many jobs are not advertised.

FITTER Also known as a “fast fitter,” this specialized role involves repairing, testing, and fitting vehicle parts, including tires, brakes, exhausts, and batteries.



MOTOR VEHICLE TECHNICIAN

You perform preventative and repair work to make vehicles roadworthy. With experience, you could move into a senior workshop role or maintain a fleet of vehicles for a commercial firm.



MOBILE TECHNICIAN Assists drivers whose vehicles have broken down. Mobile technicians drive to the motorist's location, inspect the vehicle for faults, and make any necessary repairs or tow the vehicle to a repair center or to the driver's home.



AIR-CONDITIONING/ REFRIGERATION TECHNICIAN

Specializes in the repair and maintenance of air-conditioning systems, handling any refrigerants in a manner that meets statutory safety requirements.